



Post 26/11 Response

A TOTAL FAILURE

As part of its 'War on Terror' campaign, India Today forms a Board of Experts on Security and Terror to keep the issue on top of the public agenda. Highlights of its first meeting:

Aroon Purie: I want to give you a background of how the Board of Experts on Security and Terror (BEST) has been set up. It was after 26/11 when, besides the horror of the event, it was how India dealt with this audacious attack. I don't subscribe to the theory that people suddenly started paying attention to it because it was a five-star hotel and because it was people like us who were affected. People have died in terror attacks before and there has never been such a reaction.

The attack was so audacious, it was not just somebody leaving a bomb and walking away, it was at another level. It also exposed the faults within our system which shocked the people. The fact that there was something not working right with various bodies which are supposed to deal with security and terror—whether intelligence, navy, police and so on.

When this happened, INDIA TODAY decided it should have a campaign, 'War on Terror' where we gathered public

opinion. We had a campaign where people signed a pledge—over one lakh people registered on our website—and we pledged to carry this forward because as happens very often in India, an event happens, everybody reacts, and then everybody forgets and we go back to normal.

We are of course not the Government. We can't solve anything in that sense, but we can have a discussion, we can look at what the Government is doing, review how far we have gone in terms